Constitution of Joint Student Chapter UTEP SHPE//MAES
Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers
Latinos in Science and Engineering
at The University of Texas at El Paso

PREAMBLE

The Joint Student Chapter of SHPE//MAES, Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers and Latinos in Science and Engineering, aims to:

1. Promote the professional advancement of minority students enrolled in STEM fields.
2. Increase the number of minority students enrolled in STEM at the University of Texas at El Paso.
3. Provide a space for networking and mentorship for all minority students.
4. Promote the advancement of minorities in engineering and science in both employment and education.
5. Improve the retention of minority students enrolled in engineering and science.
6. Provide a forum for the exchange of information pertinent to minority engineering/science students enrolled at The University of Texas at El Paso.
7. Develop a working network with local schools to encourage minority students to enter engineering and science fields.
8. Promote professional advancement for minority engineers and scientists by fostering cooperation among industry, government, and the academic and professional entities to improve educational and employment opportunities.
9. Provide counseling and financial assistance to minority students in engineering and science.

This chapter will be an affiliated chapter of the Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) and the Latinos in Science and Engineering (MAES). This organization possesses the right to adopt its own rules and regulations in accordance with both The University of Texas at El Paso's rules and regulations. This chapter falls under SHPE Region V and MAES Region II. In case of conflicts or policy discrepancies, The University of Texas at El Paso's policies will take precedence over the policies of SHPE and MAES.

Article I – NAME

The official designation of this organization shall be SHPE//MAES, which shall stand for the full titles of "Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers" and "Latinos and Science and Engineering."

Article II – STATEMENT OF UNIVERSITY COMPLIANCE

This organization is a recognized student organization at The University of Texas at El Paso and adheres to all campus policies as set forth in the Handbook of Operating Procedures as outlined by the Office of the Vice President for Business Affairs and the Registered Student Organization Handbook as outlined by the Student Engagement & Leadership Center at The University of Texas at El Paso.

Article III – UNIVERSITY POLICIES

Non-Discrimination Policy: Accordance with the UTEP Student Organization Handbook, this organization may not deny membership on the basis of race, color, religion, national origin, gender, age, disability, citizenship, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression, except that a registered student organization created primarily for religious purposes may restrict the right to vote or hold office to persons who subscribe to the registered student organization's statement of faith; and a registered student organization may restrict membership based on the provisions of Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972.

Prohibition of Hazing Policy: Hazing in state educational institutions is prohibited by both state law (Sections 51.936, 37.151 (5) and (6), and 37.155, Texas Education Code) and by the Rules and Regulations of The Board of Regents of The University of Texas System, Series: 50101, Section 2.8). Individuals or organizations engaging in hazing could be subject to fines and charged with criminal offenses. Additionally, the law does not affect or in any way restrict the right of the University to enforce its own rules against hazing. For more information on UTEP's hazing policy, please visit UTEP's Handbook of Operating Procedures, Chapter 1, Section 1.2.3(g).

Title IX of the Education Amendment of 1972: Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex in educational programs and activities at the university unless such programs and activities are specifically exempt from the law. The university is required to be in compliance with the provisions of Title IX. Therefore, compliance with Title IX is a condition to be a registered student organization at the university. Since passage of this law and the publication of the implementing regulations, the U. S. Department of Education Office of Civil Rights has evolved a rather clear set of criteria for determining when single sex organizations are exempt from the provisions of Title IX. The criteria are as follows: the organization must have tax-exempt status under Section 501 of the Internal Revenue Code; members must be limited to students, staff or faculty at The University of Texas at El Paso; the organization must be a "social fraternity" as defined by the Department of Education.

Prohibition of gifts or contracts with a Foreign Adversary Policy: In accordance with Texas Education Code Section 51B.103, this organization may not 1) accept a gift from a foreign adversary or an agent of a foreign adversary (as defined in Section 51B.001); or 2) enter into a contract or agreement with a foreign adversary or an agent of a foreign adversary under which the student organization receives financial support. This organization further recognizes, notwithstanding Section 51.9315, UTEP may not provide any benefit to this organization and shall terminate the organization's recognition or registration, as applicable, if it is determined that the organization has violated state law. Additionally, this organization recognizes that TEC Section 51B.103 does not prohibit this organization from accepting member dues or fees.

Article IV – MEMBERSHIP & ELIGIBILITY

Texas Board of Regent's Statement: At the beginning of each academic year, each registered student or group must file with the appropriate institutional officer an affidavit stating that the organization or group does not, and will not during the year, have as a member any person who is not a student or a member of the faculty or staff of the institution.

Members must be in good standing to retain all the rights and privileges of membership, such as eligibility to accept an officer nomination, to vote, and to attend regional/national conferences. A member must attend at least one event such as a general meeting, workshop or social event organized by the organization to be considered active.

A merit/demerit-based point system will be used to keep track of member participation accurately and fairly:

a. Merit shall be given to members that show active participation in chapter-related events, including but not limited to local, regional, and national events.
b. Demerit shall be given to members that fail to fulfill the previous commitment, as well as show unprofessional and/or unethical behavior in chapter events, including but not limited to local, regional, and national events.

To be considered an official member of the local chapter, the student must join the organization on Minetracker. The students will be encouraged to become an official SHPE and/or MAES National member but are not obliged to.

Article V – OFFICERS

Section 1: Officer Composition and Terms of Office

Executive board officers shall include *Section 2*, consisting of:

1. President
2. Vice-President of Internal Affairs
3. Vice-President of External Affairs
4. Vice-President of Communications
5. Secretary
6. Treasurer
7. Internal Operations Lead
8. Director of Communications
9. Director of Academics
10. Director of MemberSHPE
11. Director of Operations
12. Director of Outreach
13. Director of SHPEtinas
14. Director of Community Engagement
15. Director of Research
16. Director of Technology
17. Student Advisor

Chair officers shall include *Section 3*, consisting of:

1. Graduate & Alumni Chair
2. Engagement and Support Chair
3. Junior Chapter Chair
4. Marketing Chair
5. SHPEtinas Internal Chair
6. SHPEtinas External Chair
7. Fundraising Chair
8. Academics Chair

Committees shall include *Section 4*, consisting of:

1. Academic Committee
2. Website Committee
3. Community Engagement Committee
4. Operations Committee
5. Outreach Committee
6. Marketing Committee
7. MemberSHPE Committee
8. SHPEtinas Committee

Teams shall include *Section 5*, consisting of:

1. Miner Spark Team
2. Website Team
3. AppDev Team
4. S.U.N. Team

The term of office is one full year. Most of the officers must be University of Texas at El Paso undergraduate students, and only University of Texas at El Paso students may serve as officers. Chair positions listed in *Section 3* shall be considered as officers, but not part of the Executive Board, and they are supervised by the Internal Operations Lead. Committee positions listed in *Section 4* and Team positions listed in *Section* 5 are not considered as officers nor part of the Executive Board. All officers/representatives must be currently enrolled students at the University and maintain at least a minimum 2.0 grade point average per University Policy.

Section 2: Executive Board Officers

I – President

a. The President shall represent the chapter and be responsible for all matters pertaining to the chapter.
b. The President shall have full authority in the management and operations of the chapter, setting and establishing all chapter policies and overseeing its various functions and activities.

c. The President shall serve as the official spokesperson for the chapter, supervise the other officers, and manage the day-to-day affairs of the chapter.
d. The President will be held liable for tallying election votes.

II –Vice-President of Internal Affairs

a. The Vice-President of Internal Affairs shall support the President in all matters pertaining to the chapter and assume the role of the President in their absence.
b. The Vice-President of Internal Affairs will also be responsible for affairs within the university, including but not limited to conference coordination, department relations, campus relations, and national organization reports.
c. The Vice-President of Internal Affairs will be responsible for registering the organization with the university each academic year and for reviewing and updating the organization's constitution/by-laws.
d. The Vice-President of Internal Affairs will be responsible for managing the organization's academic calendar and keeping Minetracker updated.

III –Vice-President of External Affairs

a. The Vice-President of External Affairs shall be responsible for contacting companies for potential sponsorship and partnership opportunities and for submitting sponsorship applications.
b. The Vice-President of External Affairs will also be responsible for reaching out to professionals for any events that require workshops to be hosted.
c. The Vice-President of External Affairs will be responsible for updating the annual sponsorship package.

IV – Vice-President of Communications

a. The Vice-President of Communications shall serve as the head of all social and communication platforms for the chapter, overseeing the chapter's overall public-facing presence and brand identity.
b. The Vice-President of Communications will oversee the Director of Communications, Director of MemberSHPE, and Director of Operations, and will delegate tasks to each related to the communications and operational goals for the academic year.
c. The Vice-President of Communications will be responsible for ensuring consistency of the SHPE//MAES brand identity and messaging across all chapter platforms, events, and materials.

V – Secretary

a. The Secretary will take minutes during the Executive Board meetings, and attendance of the officers.
b. The Secretary will be in charge of creating member check-in and check-out forms for all organizational events such as general meetings, workshop events, and socials.
c. The Secretary will be in charge of creating a master list of all 1xxx/2xxx level engineering courses for early in-class recruiting purposes.
d. The Secretary will be responsible for creating a list of who will be traveling to the SHPE and MAES national and regional conferences.
e. The Secretary will be responsible for a Monthly Events Report in coordination with the Director of MemberSHPE.

VI – Treasurer

a. The Treasurer will keep books and records on money received, disbursed, and promised.

b. The Treasurer shall make monthly, quarterly, and yearly financial reports, along with any other time one is needed, listing all liabilities and assets of the organization to the Executive Board.
c. It will be the Treasurer's responsibility to present an annual budget and complete financial reports to the Executive Board and the National Boards of SHPE and MAES.
d. The Treasurer will oversee the Fundraising Chair listed in Section 3 point VII, and will delegate tasks to the Fundraising Chair related to the fundraising goals for the academic year.

VII – Internal Operations Lead

a. The Internal Operations Lead will be responsible for contacting other student organizations to create collaborations events such workshops, info sessions, socials, etc.
b. The Internal Operations Lead will report to the President regarding any questions and issues related to the Chairs and Committees.
c. In charge of Chairs and Committees
d. The Internal Operations Lead will be responsible for developing the MentorSHPE program and overseeing the pairing of mentors with 2-3 mentees each.

VIII – Director of Communications

a. The Director of Communications will be responsible for obtaining all chapter memorabilia. This includes photographs of all events and any items that are deemed important to the chapter as a keepsake.
b. The Director of Communications will be responsible for managing all social media platforms and following the SHPE//MAES identity. Platforms include: Instagram, Whatsapp, LinkedIn, Linktree and all relevant platforms.
c. The Director of Communications will also be responsible in the advertising/marketing of chapter events, such as social events, general meetings, and workshops. They will design all flyers for all SHPE//MAES events.
d. The Director of Communication will also be responsible for all external and internal correspondence.
e. The Director of Communications will be in charge of forming their own Marketing Committee listed in *Section 4 point VI*. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the Communications goals for the academic year.
f. The Director of Communications will be in charge of overseeing the Marketing Chair listed in Section 3 point IV. They will delegate tasks to the chair related to the Communications goals for the academic year.

IX – Director of Academics

a. The Director of Academics will be responsible for organizing all academic events, they are also responsible for collaborating with other student organizations for said events.
b. The Director of Academics will be responsible for organizing Study Mondays and all technical workshops outside of Professional Development Workshops. Some examples for technical workshops would include ANSYS or Fusion workshops, or Circuit design, etc.
c. The Director of Academics will be in charge of forming their own Academic Committee listed in Section 4 point I. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the Academic goals for the academic year.
d. The Director of Academics will oversee the Academics Chair listed in Section 3 point VIII, and will delegate tasks to the Academics Chair related to the academic goals for the academic year.

X – Director of MemberSHPE

a. The Director of MemberSHPE will be in charge of recruiting members along with managing their membership applications. By doing so, they will be setting up any recruitment opportunities such as tabling events during orientations and during the academic year.
b. The Director of MemberSHPE will be in charge of the MemberSHPE Committee listed in Section 4 point VII. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the MemberSHPE goals of the academic year.
c. The Director of MemberSHPE will be in charge of managing the Point System, where member attendance to events is recorded.
d. The Director of MemberSHPE will be in charge of creating chapter datapoints and demographics, and for keeping the member roster updated.

XI – Director of Operations

a. The Director of Operations will be in charge of reserving rooms for all SHPE//MAES events. They will also be in charge of reserving rooms with the required occupancy.
b. The Director of Operations will be responsible for determining food logistics, such as picking up and/or delivering the food. They will be the point of contact (POC) for food delivery.
c. The Director of Operations will be responsible for prepping/cleaning the room before and after each event.
d. The Director of Operations will be in charge of the Operations Committee listed in *Section 4 point IV*. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the Operations goals of the academic year.

XII –Director of Outreach

a. The Director of Outreach will be responsible for contacting K-12 schools to establish Junior SHPE Chapters.
b. The Director of Outreach will be in charge of selecting Junior SHPE Chapters Representatives, such as Advisors and Officers. They will also oversee the Junior Chapter's activities.
c. The Director of Outreach will be in charge of organizing Noche de Ciencias and applying for financial support with SHPE National.
d. The Director of Outreach will be in charge of contacting local non-profit organizations to organize K-12 outreach events related to STEM.
e. The Director of Outreach will be in charge of forming their own Outreach Committee listed in *Section 4 point V*. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the Outreach goals for the academic year.
f. The Director of Outreach will be in charge of overseeing the Junior Chapter Chair listed in *Section 3 point III*. They will delegate tasks to the chair related to the Outreach goals for the academic year.

XIII – Director of SHPEtinas

a. The Director of SHPEtinas will be in charge of forming their own SHPEtinas Committee listed in *Section 4 point VIII*. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the SHPEtinas goals for the academic year.
b. The Director of SHPEtinas will be in charge overseeing the SHPEtinas Internal Chair listed in *Section 3 point V* and the SHPEtinas External Chair listed in *Section 3 point VI*. They will delegate tasks to the chair related to the SHPEtinas goals for the academic year.
c. The Director of SHPEtinas is in charge of organizing events catered to women in STEM, such as social events and workshops.

d. The Director of SHPEtinas is responsible for contacting and organizing events with companies for SHPEtinas.

XIV –Director of Community Engagement

a. The Director of Community Engagement is responsible for coordinating social events by organizing gatherings that are fun and engaging for members.
b. The Director of Community Engagement oversees athletics by planning, organizing, and managing the logistics of sports activities.
c. The Director of Community Engagement organizes volunteer opportunities by collaborating with organizations outside of UTEP to promote community involvement and service.

XV –Director of Research

a. The Director of Research will be responsible for overseeing and promoting research opportunities for SHPE//MAES members, including undergraduate research programs, faculty research connections, and national research competitions.
b. The Director of Research will organize and lead the Miner Spark Team, coordinating project-based initiatives that give members hands-on experience in engineering research and innovation.
c. The Director of Research will collaborate with faculty advisors, and other university research centers to establish pathways for members to engage in scholarly and applied research.
d. The Director of Research will report to and meet regularly with the Vice-President of Internal Affairs regarding the status of research initiatives and the Miner Spark Team.

XVI –Director of Technology

a. The Director of Technology will oversee all technology-related initiatives for the organization, including the maintenance and development of digital platforms, tools, and resources used by SHPE//MAES members and officers.
b. The Director of Technology will lead and manage the Website Team and the AppDev Team, delegating tasks related to the development, design, and upkeep of the organization's website and mobile applications.
c. The Director of Technology will coordinate with the Director of Communications and other officers to ensure that all digital infrastructure supports organizational goals, including event promotion, member engagement, and data management.
d. The Director of Technology will report to and meet regularly with the Vice-President of Internal Affairs regarding the status of all technology teams and digital projects.
e. The Director of Technology will be in charge of overseeing the Website Committee listed in Section 4 point II. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the website goals for the academic year.

XVII –Student Advisor

a. The student advisor will serve as the point of contact for the organization when seeking general advice or knowledge on how previous boards handled problems or what programs and strategies they implemented.
b. This position is intended to serve as the link between the current and former boards, and it will preferably be held by the exiting President or Vice-President.

Section 3: Chairs Officers

I – Graduate & Alumni Chair

a. The Graduate & Alumni Chair shall encourage graduate students to join the UTEP SHPE/MAES chapter and collaborate with the Director of MemberSHPE on graduate student recruitment.
b. The Graduate & Alumni Chair will work alongside the Secretary to oversee the MentorSHPE program, supporting mentorship between undergraduate members, graduate students, and alumni.
c. The Graduate & Alumni Chair is responsible for organizing the Graduate Mixer to provide networking opportunities for graduate students, as well as planning alumni events that foster connections between alumni and current members.
d. The Graduate & Alumni Chair is responsible for maintaining relationships with alumni by gathering feedback on their experiences, implementing systems to facilitate ongoing alumni engagement, and supporting professional networking opportunities between members and alumni, including connections with companies and industries.

II – Engagement and Support Chair

a. The Engagement and Support chair will assist the Internal Operations Lead with the planning and execution of large-scale events.
b. The Engagement and Support Chair will help promote the success of international students by finding opportunities and helping plan workshops and events that address their goals.
c. Provides general support for SHPE/MAES events, including academic, cultural, and professional activities, as needed by other officers.

III –Junior Chapter Chair

a. The Junior Chapter Chair will be responsible in assisting the Director of Outreach in overseeing the Outreach Committee listed in *Section 4 point V*. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the Outreach goals for the academic year.
b. The Junior Chapter Chair shall act as a connection between the UTEP Student Chapter SHPE//MAES and the corresponding Junior SHPE Chapter School.
c. The Junior Chapter Chair must include the Advisor in the school and if applicable, the executive board of officers within the school.
d. The Junior Chapter Chair will report to the Director of Outreach and Outreach Committee for bi-weekly updates, and/or questions related to the chapter

IV –Marketing Chair

a. The Marketing Chair will be responsible for taking pictures at SHPE/MAES events such as general meetings, social events, and workshops.
b. The Marketing Chair will be responsible in assisting the Director of Communications in advertising/marketing chapter events, such as social events, general meetings, and workshops.
c. The Marketing Chair will be responsible in assisting the Director of Communications in overseeing the Marketing Committee listed in *Section 4 point VI*. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the Communications goals for the academic year.

V –SHPEtinas Internal Chair

a. The SHPEtinas Internal Chair will be responsible in assisting the Director of SHPEtinas in overseeing the SHPEtinas Committee listed in Section 4 point VIII. They will delegate tasks to the committee related to the SHPEtinas goals for the academic year.
b. The SHPEtinas Internal Chair will be responsible in assisting the Director of SHPEtinas in organizing internal events catered to women in STEM, such as social events and workshops for chapter members.

VI –SHPEtinas External Chair

a. The SHPEtinas External Chair will assist the Director of SHPEtinas in contacting and organizing events with companies for SHPEtinas.
b. The SHPEtinas External Chair will assist the Director of SHPEtinas in building industry partnerships and securing sponsorship opportunities specific to SHPEtinas events.

VII –Fundraising Chair

a. The Fundraising Chair will assist the Treasurer in developing and executing fundraising initiatives to support chapter operations and travel.
b. The Fundraising Chair will identify and coordinate fundraising opportunities, such as restaurant nights, merchandise sales, and crowdfunding campaigns.
c. The Fundraising Chair will report to the Treasurer regarding fundraising progress and funds raised.

VIII –Academics Chair

a. The Academics Chair will assist the Director of Academics in overseeing the Academic Committee listed in Section 4 point I.
b. The Academics Chair will assist the Director of Academics in organizing academic-focused events and initiatives, such as study sessions, tutoring resources, and workshops.

Section 4: Committees

I – Academic Committee

a. The Academic Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of Academic in the planning and organizing of all events related to academics.

II –Website Committee

a. The Website Committee will assist the Director of Technology in maintaining and updating the chapter website, and will support the Director of Communications in keeping members informed.

III –Community Engagement Committee

a. The Community Engagement Committee will be responsible for assisting the Community Engagement Director in the planning and organizing of all events related to the Community Engagement Director.

IV – Operations Committee

a. The Operations Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of Operations with determining food logistics, such as picking up and/or delivering the food.
b. The Operations Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of Operations with prepping/cleaning the room before and after each event.

V –Outreach Committee

a. The Outreach Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of Outreach and Junior Chapter Chair by contacting and/or establishing POCs with high schools in the city of El Paso.
b. The Outreach Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of Outreach by organizing the Noche de Ciencias event during the Spring.

VI –Marketing Committee

a. The Marketing Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of Communications and Marketing Chair with the creation of flyers, managing social media platforms, etc.

VII –MemberSHPE Committee

a. The MemberSHPE Committee will be responsible for assisting the Director of MemberSHPE in any tasks related to members, such as keeping track of all members in the system.

VIII – SHPEtinas Committee

a. The SHPEtinas Committee will be responsible for acting as the board of the Director of SHPEtinas and SHPEtinas Chair. They shall be responsible for organizing and planning events related to SHPEtinas.

Section 5: Teams

Teams differ from Committees in that they are project-focused groups with defined deliverables and technical scope. Team members are recruited through an application process and are expected to commit to the team's goals for the duration of the academic year. Each Team reports directly to its corresponding Director. The Teams of SHPE//MAES are:

XVIII –Miner Spark Team

a. The Miner Spark Team operates under the Director of Research and is responsible for leading engineering project initiatives that promote research, innovation, and technical skill development within the SHPE//MAES community.
b. Team members are recruited annually through an application process managed by the Director of Research.

XIX –Website Team

a. The Website Team operates under the Director of Technology and is responsible for the design, development, maintenance, and continuous improvement of the SHPE//MAES chapter website.
b. Team members are expected to have or develop skills in web technologies and will coordinate with the Director of Communications to keep members informed via the website.

XX –AppDev Team

a. The AppDev Team operates under the Director of Technology and is responsible for the development and maintenance of the SHPE//MAES mobile application and any other custom software tools that serve the organization's membership.
b. Team members are expected to have or develop skills in mobile and software development. The AppDev Team will work closely with the Website Team to ensure cohesive and integrated digital experiences for SHPE//MAES members.

XXI –S.U.N. Team

a. The S.U.N. Team (Summer Undergraduate Network) operates under the Director of Academics and serves as advisors for members participating in SUN projects, providing mentorship and guidance throughout the project cycle.
b. Team members will be responsible for reviewing the technical work of S.U.N. project participants and providing feedback to support their development.
c. Team members are recruited through an application process managed by the Director of Academics.

Section 6: Selection Process

Members of the executive board are selected for the academic year during general elections as described in *Article IX*, except for the Dir. of Technology and Student Advisor Positions:

a. The Dir. of Technology position shall be appointed by the incoming Executive Board each year by opening an application and conducting interviews, in order to ensure the person has the technical expertise required for web development.
b. The Student Advisor shall also be appointed by the incoming Executive Board, but the exiting President or Vice-President should always be the first option.

In the case that positions are still vacant after elections, Resignation, *Section 7*, or Impeachment, *Section 8*, happen, selection process will be as follows:

a. Eligible board members will apply for the role
b. Executive board not applied to vacant role will select top three (3) participants
c. Officers will hold a vote to select new officer position.

Section 7: Resignations

a. A letter of resignation shall be submitted to the President and/or Vice-Presidents by any person willing to resign from office at least a week before the next general meeting.
b. During a meeting when a resignation is presented, the resigning officer shall continue to fulfill the duties of office until replacement has been assigned.
c. The process for an officer vacant position will be offered based in the line of succession from the chapter, if no replacement occurs, nominations will be taken to fill the position. A person shall be elected by the Executive Board during a special nomination meeting through secret ballot.

Section 8: Impeachments

a. When any officer feels that an officer is not fulfilling their duties, they may call upon the executive officers to call a special meeting within the next week to discuss/resolve the matter.
b. During the impeachment proceedings the case will be presented. The officer under investigation will be given the opportunity to present their defense before the final vote.
c. A two-thirds vote, excluding the investigated officer, is needed for the impeachment to be carried out.
d. In the event the impeachment is carried out, a new candidate will be nominated and elected as described under Article V Section 6.

Article VI – MEETINGS

Section 1: Definition of Quorum

A quorum shall consist of fifty percent of all members and a majority of the executive officers.

Section 2: General Meetings

The executive board shall call general meetings, whereas a minimum of one meeting per major academic semester month shall be held.

Section 3: Executive Board Meetings

Executive board members shall hold meetings weekly with six or more of the officers present.
All Executive Board and Board of Directors members are required to attend at least one chapter-hosted event per week throughout the academic year. Exceptions must be formally requested in advance and approved by the President or the relevant Vice-President. Failure to meet this requirement without prior approval constitutes an unexcused absence.
All Executive Board and Board of Directors members are required to attend all officer meetings.
Accumulation of three (3) unexcused absences (“strikes”) from weekly events or three (3) officer meeting strikes subjects the board member to impeachment proceedings as outlined in Article V, Section 8.

In addition to full officer meetings, the following individual 1:1 check-in meetings shall be held regularly: the President shall meet 1:1 with each Executive Board member; the Vice-President of Internal Affairs shall hold regular meetings with the Directors of Academics, Research, SHPEtinas, and Technology; the Vice-President of Communications shall hold regular meetings with the Directors of Communications, MemberSHPE, and Operations; the Vice-President of External Affairs shall hold regular meetings with the Directors of Community Engagement and Outreach. These check-ins are intended to ensure accountability, facilitate communication, and provide support to each director in fulfilling their responsibilities.

Article VII - UNIVERSITY ADVISOR

Section 1: Advisor Requirements

This organization may have a University Advisor who is at least twenty-one years of age, is not enrolled as a student at the University, and serves as either:

a. A part-time or full-time employee of the University
b. A representative of a national organization that is associated with the registered student organization.
c. Must also satisfy one of the following:
    i. Currently a part-time or full-time employee of the University of Texas at El Paso
    ii. Currently a representative of a national organization that is associated with the registered student organization (registered student organizations only)

The advisor's field of study should be in the engineering or science fields, but it is not mandatory. The chapter officials shall choose and vote on an appropriate person for this position following the organization's elections. The advisor acts as an ex-officio member and cannot vote.

Section 2: Advisor Duties

The advisor's duties are:

a. The advisor should assist the officers in organization decisions and offer counsel.
b. The advisor is encouraged to attend the organization's meetings and sponsored trips.
c. The advisor should assume an active role in the organization and provide all necessary and proper support.

Article VIII – FINANCES

Section 1: Membership

Members are encouraged to pay a national SHPE $10 USD fee. Any local fees are paid to the chapter by cash directly or by corresponding commercial applications for the purpose (CashApp, Venmo). SHPE National membership fee is paid through the SHPE National website.

Section 2: Disbursements

a. All disbursement of funds must be approved by the President and Treasurer and signed by the Advisor. Only the President and Treasurer will have access to financial accounts.
b. The treasurer is responsible for managing any request and spending of funds with the Student Engagement & Leadership Center or with Business Center specialists.

Section 3: Fund Disbursement due to Inactivity

If the organization becomes inactive, or loses registration status at UTEP, funds will be dispersed to the College of Engineering. If said option is not feasible, all funds will be dispersed to the Student Organization Advancement Fund, managed by the Student Engagement & Leadership Center.

Article IX – ELECTIONS

Section 1: Nominations

a. Nominations are to be made in a general meeting held at least two weeks prior to the university's club Coordination Council's deadline for submitting annual reports. Members are notified through social media and email at least two weeks before the election.

b. Only members as defined in Article III may accept nominations.

c. Candidates may be nominated for more than one office but can only hold one position.

d. Nominations for President and Vice-President are only contingent on past officers who have served for at least one calendar year to be eligible to run for election.

Section 2: President Election

a. The President election will run separately from the Executive Board elections.
b. The President election shall be determined by a weighted vote: seventy percent (70%) of the final vote will be cast by the current Executive Board, weighted based on their assessment of each candidate's performance and achievements during the academic year; the remaining thirty percent (30%) will be cast by the general membership (community vote). The two vote totals will be calculated separately and combined according to these weights to determine the final result.

Section 3: Executive Board Election

a. Elections shall occur in the following order: Vice-Presidents, Directors, Treasurer, and Secretary.
b. Vice-President elections shall be determined by a weighted vote: fifty percent (50%) of the final vote will be cast by the current Executive Board, and fifty percent (50%) will be cast by the general membership (community vote). The two vote totals will be calculated separately and combined according to these weights to determine the final result. All other Executive Board positions (Directors, Treasurer, and Secretary) shall be elected by the general membership vote only, as described in this section.
c. Only members in good standing, as defined previously in Article IV, and who are present at the time of elections, unless it is an online vote, are eligible to vote.
d. Voting shall be by secret ballot, either online or paper vote, with tallying conducted in the absence of the candidates.
e. In the event that there is no majority vote, the top two vote receivers will participate in a runoff election.
f. Members of the executive board may vote for all elections, but in the event of a tie, only the executive board can break the tie.
g. Officers may be re-elected.
h. In the event that an officer is re-nominated, they may not vote in breaking a tie for the position they are voting for.
i. Tie breaking vote order: Vice-Presidents, Secretary, Treasurer, Internal Operations Lead, and Directors.

Section 4: New Board Transition

The newly elected officers shall undergo a transitional period in which the old officers shall introduce the new officers to the responsibilities and duties of the respective officers.

Section 5: New Board Start

The newly elected officers shall begin their term at the beginning of April during the spring semester.

Article X – AMENDMENTS

a. Any proposed amendments shall be submitted in writing to the membership at a general meeting by the Executive Board.

b. A favorable vote of two thirds of the members on the issue is required for amendment passage.
c. The amendment shall be submitted to the SHPE National Board, MAES National Board, and the University of Texas at El Paso Student Engagement & Leadership Center for approval.

Article XI –RATIFICATIONS

This is the final version of the constitution that was effective upon approval by a majority vote of members present at an executive board meeting. Carried out on Saturday, July 5th, 2025, virtually.